

From Concept to Completion: **Navigating Today's Affordable and Supportive Housing Landscape**

Hosted by London Community Foundation
and its Housing Action Committee

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Thursday, March 6, 2025

London, Ontario



LONDON
COMMUNITY
FOUNDATION



Program Overview

- 8:00 a.m.** ● **Registration and refreshments**
- 8:30 a.m.** ● **Welcome from Diane Silva, *President & CEO*, London Community Foundation**
- 8:50 a.m.** ● **Session #1: *Understanding the Affordable and Supportive Housing Landscape in London and Middlesex***
- Moderator: **Teresa Hollingsworth**, *Chair*, London Community Foundation Housing Action Committee
- Speakers: **Abe Oudshoorn**, *Associate Professor and Acting Associate Dean Research, Faculty of Health Sciences, Western University*
Greg Playford, *President, Devonshire Consulting*
- 9:25 a.m.** ● **Session #2: *Getting Started: Organizational Readiness***
- Moderator: **Fred Galloway**, *Member*, London Community Foundation Housing Action Committee
- Speakers: **Sr. Joan Atkinson**, *President*, London Affordable Housing Foundation
Carmen Sprovieri, *President*, Homes Unlimited (London) Inc.
Ron Rowbottom, *Vice President*, ZerIn Development Corp.
Valerian Marochko, *Executive Director*, Cross Cultural Learner Centre

10:30 a.m. ● **Break**

10:45 a.m. ● **Session #3: Lessons Learned from Local Best Practices**

Moderator: **John Fleming**, *Principal*, City Planning Solutions

Speakers: **Roger Caranci**, *President*, Residenza Affordable Housing

Laura Gurr, *Managing Partner*, Cohen Highley

Sylvia Harris, *Development Manager*, Flourish and
Chair, Vision SoHo Alliance

Dustin Parkes, *Associate Principal*, Nicholson Sheffield Architects Inc.

11:50 a.m. ● **Session #4: How to Access Funding**

Moderator: **Greg Playford**, *President*, Devonshire Consulting

Speakers: **Matt Feldberg**, *Director*, Municipal Housing and Industrial Development,
City of London

Anny Le, *Senior Manager*, Client Relations, Canada Mortgage and
Housing Corporation

Jim Foote, *Treasurer and Vice President*, Homes Unlimited (London) Inc.

Vijay Venkatesan, *Vice President*, Finance & Operations, London
Community Foundation

1:00 p.m. ● **Lunch and Networking**

- London Community Foundation

- **Social Impact Fund**

- The Social Impact Fund unlocks London Community Foundation's assets to create positive change in the community by providing investments in affordable housing projects and social enterprises creating community impact. The Social Impact Fund has invested more than \$58 million since its inception in 2012, helping to create more than 1,700 units of affordable housing and supporting 11 social enterprise opportunities.

- Learn more about the Social Impact Fund, and how to apply, at:
www.lcf.on.ca/social-impact-fund

- **Right:** 99 Pond Mills Road was supported by the Social Impact Fund between 2019 and 2023.





Joan Atkinson

President

London Affordable Housing Foundation

Joan Atkinson is co-director of the Systemic Justice Office for the Sisters of St. Joseph of London. With a background in secondary and adult education for more than 25 years, she uses these skills in her present work of research and education on understanding issues of social inequality and injustice. She is the founder and chair of the London Affordable Housing Foundation, a non-profit group that is seeking solutions to the housing needs of the city.

Right:

1045 Nightingale Place, an affordable, 41-unit development opened in 2019 by London Affordable Housing Foundation.





Roger Caranci

President

Residenza Affordable Housing

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➤ A lifelong Londoner who believes deeply in public service, Roger has been involved for many years on several boards and commissions. As Chair of Residenza Affordable Housing, Roger leads a group of committed, civic-minded individuals who make lives better for those seeking affordable housing. The organization is about to embark on its most ambitious build yet – Residenza Victoria, which is part of the Vision SoHo Alliance – and has completed two award-winning builds, Residenza Italia and Residenza Ortona.



Matt Feldberg

Director, Municipal Housing and Industrial Development

City of London

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➤ Matt is the Director of Municipal Housing and Industrial Development in the City of London's Housing and Community Growth department. With a background in customer service, engineering, planning and development finance he and his team help affordable housing development partners navigate through the City's funding approvals process. As the City responds to the housing crisis, finding more efficient ways to deliver the services needed by the non-profit sector is core to the Municipal Housing team's goals.



John Fleming

Principal

City Planning Solutions

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John Fleming has over 30 years of experience in city planning and design. He is the former Managing Director of City Planning and Chief Planner for London, and was a member of the City's Senior Leadership Team. He is the Principal of his own planning and design consulting firm, City Planning Solutions. He has played a major role in leading large city building projects, various city-wide strategies, policy initiatives, community plans, major urban design initiatives, core area revitalization programs, and ecological and climate emergency plans.



Jim Foote

Treasurer and Vice President

Homes Unlimited (London) Inc.

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As Treasurer and Vice President at Homes Unlimited (London) Inc., Jim has been involved as a volunteer in developing and managing over 650 units of affordable housing within London. With a volunteer board of directors, Homes Unlimited (London) Inc., is the largest private non-profit housing provider with over 10 projects within the city. While remaining active with various charities, Jim has a full-time role as Assistant Vice President, Commercial Financing at First National Financial LP covering the Southern Ontario Market.



Fred Galloway

Member, Housing Action Committee
London Community Foundation

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➤ Fred Galloway is President of F.J. Galloway Associates Inc., a consultancy practice focusing on community development, facility development assessments, organizational and operational reviews, and specialized projects involving governance, risk management, partnerships, and collaborative initiatives. He was on the Board of Governors of Fanshawe College, and was Chair of the Monsignor Feeney Foundation and London Community Foundation. He is currently a Community Board member for Kings University College.



Laura Gurr

Managing Partner
Cohen Highley

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➤ Laura M. Gurr is the Managing Partner at Cohen Highley LLP, where she is a member of the Multi-Residential Housing Group. With a specialized focus on condominium law and affordable housing, Laura represents a diverse range of clients including non-profit housing providers, property managers, condominium corporations, and developers. Laura is passionate about affordable housing and is committed to equity, diversity, and inclusion initiatives. She has served on the Board of Directors for Homes Unlimited (London) Inc. since 2013.



Sylvia Harris

*Development Manager, Flourish
Chair, Vision SoHo Alliance*

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Sylvia Harris is a Development Manager with Flourish, a non-profit development services organization launched by Indwell in 2021. Prior to Flourish, Sylvia worked at Indwell assisting in the development of over 1,200 units of supportive housing across seven municipalities. Sylvia is also the Chair of the Vision SoHo Alliance, a coalition of six non-profit organizations working together to develop a 5-acre block of land in the SoHo neighbourhood into 680 units of mixed income housing.

Right:

The War Memorial Children's Hospital that is being renovated by Indwell as part of the Vision SoHo development.





Teresa Hollingsworth

Chair, Housing Action Committee

London Community Foundation

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Teresa Hollingsworth has worked in the environmental field for her entire career. She has over 40 years of experience, largely with the Upper Thames River Conservation Authority, where she is currently the Manager of Community and Corporate Services. Teresa joined the London Community Foundation Board in 2018 to help with the Foundation's desire to support a healthy Thames River and local environment. She is committed to helping the Foundation play a meaningful role in alleviating homelessness.



Anny Le

Senior Manager, Client Relations

Canada Mortgage and Housing Corporation (CMHC)

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Anny Le (pronounced Lee) is a Senior Manager with CMHC, overseeing the Greater Ontario Team of Client Solutions Specialists who manage clients accessing CMHC's Housing Programs, including the Affordable Housing Fund, the Apartment Construction Loan Program, and many other programs. She has 18 years of experience working at CMHC across its programs, including Mortgage Loan Insurance, and her experiences include establishing a corporate client experience framework and developing a new program.



Valerian Marochko

Executive Director

Cross Cultural Learner Centre

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Valerian (Valy) Marochko has been the Executive Director of the London Cross Cultural Learner Centre since 2009, where he has transformed the organization into an effective provider of refugee resettlement and newcomer settlement services. Valy has worked for the development of Collège Boréal in London and served as a consultant for international organizations such as the United Nations, the World Bank, and the Harvard Institute for International Development.



Abe Oudshoorn

Associate Professor and Acting Associate Dean Research

Faculty of Health Sciences, Western University

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Abe Oudshoorn, RN, PhD is Associate Professor and Acting Associate Dean Research in the Faculty of Health Sciences at Western University. A community health nurse by background, Dr. Oudshoorn's program of research focuses on preventing and ending homelessness, from local services to national policies and international development. Dr. Oudshoorn is also the Managing Editor of the International Journal on Homelessness.



Dustin Parkes

Associate Principal

Nicholson Sheffield Architects Inc.

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Dustin is an Associate Principal at Nicholson Sheffield Architects Inc. and has successfully led a variety of the firm's recent multi-unit residential projects. He has extensive experience in the non-profit, affordable housing sector, and has contributed to multiple award-winning affordable housing projects in London since joining the firm in 2017. He is currently overseeing the design development and construction of two of the firm's largest housing projects to date.



Greg Playford

President

Devonshire Consulting

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Greg is owner and president of Devonshire Financial, a commercial mortgage brokerage company active in arranging construction and term financing, and government loans and grants, for multi-unit residential properties. Through its sister company Devonshire Consulting, Greg has been Lead Consultant in over 30 affordable housing projects across Ontario. Greg is a long time Board member of Homes Unlimited, a London charitable non-profit that has 11 housing projects, and is a former Board Chair of London Community Foundation.



Image:

A rendering from
Nicholson Sheffield
Architects Inc. of the
Vision SoHo project.



Ron Rowbottom

Vice President

Zerin Development Corp.

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Ron Rowbottom has served as Vice President of Zerin Development Corporation for the past decade, during which Zerin expanded its footprint by constructing its second apartment building at 440 Clarke Road in London. He is currently the Chair of the new property development committee for Zerin, which oversees the construction of a 119-unit apartment building in the Vision SoHo Alliance development. Ron retired after a career in Global Facilities Management and Environmental Health and Safety for two Fortune 500 companies.

Right:

Zerin's development at 303 Commissioners Road W was assisted by a loan from the Foundation's Social Impact Fund.





Carmen Sprovieri

President

Homes Unlimited (London) Inc.

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Working in administrative and teaching positions with a Masters in Library and Information Science, Carmen is a Board member of Homes Unlimited. She has served from 2002 to the present on the Finance Committee, a number of Ad Hoc project committees and is currently President. For over 20 years she was at the London Public Library as Coordinator of Community Relations and Continuing Education.



Vijay Venkatesan

Vice President, Finance & Operations

London Community Foundation

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As Vice President, Finance & Operations at London Community Foundation, Vijay oversees finance, accounting, IT, and human resource activities. Vijay is active in the community and is currently a member of the Lawson Foundation's Audit Committee. He previously served on the Board of Directors of the London InterCommunity Health Centre and Childcan and has been a Mentor for the InSPIRE Mentoring program at Fanshawe. He obtained his chartered accountant designation in 2003.



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Working Group:

Teresa Hollingsworth – *Chair*, Housing Action Committee

Graham Porter – *Vice Chair*, Housing Action Committee

Sister Joan Atkinson

John Fleming

Michelle Foote

Fred Galloway

John Nicholson

Greg Playford

Angela Somerville

For enquiries about this event, please contact
Rachelle Lamarche, *Finance and Operations Specialist*,
London Community Foundation, at rachelle@lcf.on.ca.

Front: A rendering from Nicholson Sheffield Architects Inc.
of the Residenza Affordable Housing building at Vision SoHo.